

Participant Information Sheet



A study investigating interactive interfaces for human interactive agentic AI research tools.

Thank you for your interest in this study. Before you decide to take part, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and discuss it with others if you wish. The study organiser is available if there is anything that is not clear or if you would like more information. Take time to decide whether or not you wish to take part.

Purpose of the study

This study aims to learn the key challenges and goals in building effective interfaces for interactive and interpretable agentic AI systems used in research settings. Participants will be selected based on their domain expertise in a relevant research field as well as their interest in working with new AI systems in their work.

Participants will be asked a series of interview questions to gather their thoughts about their needs and wants in interfaces for agentic AI based systems. They may also be shown a series of proposed interface designs and components and asked for their feedback. They may also be asked to test and compare the functionality of multiple interface designs and provide their feedback. Data collected will solely include participants' responses to these questions and basic interaction events captured by the prototype interfaces. Further details are provided below.

1. **Why have I been chosen?** You have been individually selected as a domain expert of interest.
2. **Do I have to take part?** No, participation is entirely voluntary. If you do decide to take part, you can still withdraw from the study at any time, without giving any reasons.
3. **Who is organising the study?** Adam Cheng and Dr John Dudley are organising the research study. They are based in the Engineering Department at the University of Cambridge.
4. **What will happen during the study?** You will be interviewed to provide thoughts on how interface design could be most effectively used to improve your experience with agentic AI systems designed for academic research. You will also be asked to view, interact with, and compare several prototype interface designs and your feedback will be elicited.
5. **What are the possible risks of taking part?** Participants could experience mild fatigue. Breaks can be taken at any time between questions.
6. **What happens at the end of the study?** At the end of the study there will be a chance for you to ask any questions that you may have.
7. **What will happen to the study results?** The results will be written up and published in academic papers and presented at research meetings.
8. **Anonymity – will I be identified in any publications resulting from the study?** The data will be anonymised and any references to the data will be done so that you are not identifiable.
9. **What if there is a problem?** If you have a concern about any aspect of this study, you should ask to speak to the researcher(s) who will do their best to answer your questions.
10. **Who has reviewed the study?** The Department of Engineering Ethics Committee has reviewed this study through the light-touch review process.

Contact Information

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